INNOVATION MANAGEMENT

Capsule 2

What is innovation?

An essential definition for this course: what is innovation?

Innovation is often confused with invention. They are not the same thing. Invention is the good idea, the “eureka!” moment. There are also perfectly useless, even far-fetched inventions that will never really be adopted: interesting ideas that find no use.

Innovation is something else: it is the realisation of novelty.

This word, “realisation”, is central. An invention becomes an innovation when it moves into action, when it is implemented, when it finds its market, when it becomes part of everyday habits.

More analytically, innovation can be defined as the process of putting something new into practice in order to create value.

Managing innovation means managing this process.

And this goes far beyond the question of creativity, because having a good idea is only a very small part of the journey, the first steps. The longest and most difficult part is all the work that remains to turn the good idea into something that works, that finds its market, that creates value. It is precisely this work that this course will teach you to manage.

Another useful point: the word innovation refers both to a process and to an outcome. When I say that a product is an innovation, I am talking about the outcome. When I ask how a company managed to create this product, I am talking about the process. In this course, we will talk about both, but the main question will be the process: how to develop a company’s ability to implement new things that create value.

English translation of the French script reviewed and approved by the instructor (September 2026). In the video, the image and voice are generated by an AI avatar of the instructor.